

The official MUNOB Magazine

No. 9

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MUNOB 2022



foto by Filip Fulea



WELCOME TO MUNOB 2022

As silence swept over the main hall of the Mihai Viteazul College, we all realized we were once again participating in an extraordinary event. The sea of black, blue and white was anxiously waiting for the start of the opening ceremony, trembling with emotion. After the warm welcome and the numerous photos, you could literally feel the excitement in the air. Smiles were shining across the room, some still covered by the ever so present masks. After all, this was the very first MUNOB meeting in over two years, following the Covid Pandemic, a time in which not one, but two entire conferences were canceled and delayed repeatedly.



So, what is MUNOB ?

The Model United Nations of Bucharest (short form MUNOB) is an activity in which students from the capital of our country play the role of delegates of the United Nations and simulate UN conferences. Each diplomat represents another country and they are required to respect that state's values and interests. The aim is to produce resolutions to modern problems or fictional ones, that teach the youngsters the ropes of nowadays diplomacy. There are a total of 6 committees that are moderated by chairpersons.

MUN is a fun social activity that can tremendously help with shyness, developing skills such as public speaking, debating, teamwork, critical thinking and of course research as participants have to make sure to represent their country in the most authentic way possible. MUNOB conferences should take place annually, but unfortunately this wasn't the case the last two years, as the Covid 19 pandemic made such a convention impossible due to health concerns.

Yet there we were, finally together, ready to relive the incredible adventure that shaped so many lives, introducing them to the very essence of diplomatic conversation, and the fabric of modern politics.

Once the room had finally come to rest, the President of the General Assembly, Teodora Stefan, took the microphone and introduced the restless crowd to the special guests, not forgetting to thank the sponsors as well. First up was the principal of the school, Liliana Zachevici, whose effort and determination were essential to this meeting. Following her, was professor and inspector Alexandru Croitoru, who reminded us that MUNOB was not only an incredible event, but a tradition that has been kept for more than 10 years, making it the longest running highschool event in Bucharest. The next guest on stage was the former minister of Education, Mister Remus Pricopie.





The main focus of his speech was asking the question 'Why?'. He wanted us to do an introspection and to find out why we were there instead of 'in a park or at the mall'. He also touched on the fact that his daughter, now studying with the FLEX program in the US, still ranks Mihai Viteazul National College as the best educational institution she ever attended.



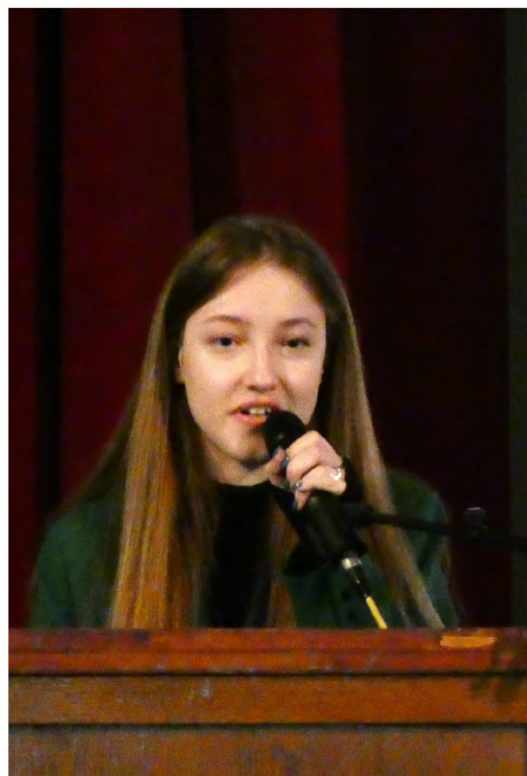
This is proof that the Romanian school, although often illspoken, is still one of the best in the world.

Following was Teodor Matei, now a successful banker and student of Bocconi University in Milan. He emphasized that if we believe that our voices don't matter, then we should think twice. The speech was inspired by the famous J.F.K. inaugural address, that we should try to build "a city upon a hill" ourselves, focusing on individual responsibility.

Lastly, the Secretary General, Fabiana Severin, took the microphone and reminded us of the modern problems that have shattered our dreams of global peace, and that was our responsibility, as well, to try and understand and come up with solutions, using diplomatic dialogue, in the spirit of the MUNOB meetings. In the end she announced, to the crowd's craze, the conference, finally open!

After the shower of applause ended, we all took a 10 minute breather, after which the rolecall started. Every country, starting in alphabetical order from Australia, stated its stand on modern problems such as the war on drugs, autonomous weapons, the Hong Kong situation and, of course, the ever so frightful Donbass war. In general, all countries opposed the use of fully autonomous weapons, stating that there should be at least some human control over them.

And there we were, at the end of the first day of MUNOB 2022, somewhat in awe of what we had just experienced. After that, everyone headed out, going home or to party, leaving the Mihai Viteazul College quiet for the rest of the night, in anticipation of the arrival of the group for intense conferencing the following day.





MEET THE LEGENDS

Who are the people behind the curtains?

Let's start from the very top. Fabiana Severin is our proud Secretary General, making sure all the wheels are kept in motion and well greased. She is the big boss in deference to whom we all bow.



Next in the hierarchy of power is our lovely Deputy Secretary General, Alexandra Hobai. With a heart of gold and an iron fist, she stands tall and looks down upon us mortals. She is in charge with keeping everything in check.

Another powerful young woman, Teodora Stefan, is our President of the General Assembly. She is the one that tells people to shut up, to hold the bloody placard up, and pounds the wooden hammer each time there is not enough silence in the room.



Her protégé, Mihai Sisu, is Vice president of General Assembly, and, some say, also a love interest for most of the female participants (there were so many notes in the gossip box wondering if he was single that we lost track of them). He is in charge of making sure that everyone is getting along just nicely.

GOSSIP BOX

Hottie or overrated? You tell us! Known by many, questioned multiple times about his relationship status and having been the subject of the juiciest gossip, the deputy President of General Assembly, Mihai Sisu, might be the most sought-after boy from MUNOB 2022. What is his secret?



Moving on to my immediate bosses, the **Chiefs of Press**

Mihai Filat, a.k.a the Sorcerer of Photoshop, is there for every banner, sticker or badge needed.



Filp Fulea, a talented photographer and future architect, is the guy that blinds you with the flash of the camera.



Last but not least, there is Filip Cirtog. He might not impress in his humble attire but he surely is the working type (and the pizza boy) that makes sure the flow of information never stops.

Then there's me. Chief editor and chief reporter.
My name is Bradescu Matei.
"I'm press and I impress"

Following her gut and sometimes my comand, here is Andra Lefticariu. In charge with the spicy gossip she brings you up to date on the good stuff



Jumping from Press to **Entertainment**, meet the Aphrodite and our very own Dionysus:

Marisa Amato and Mihai Ailincai are the mythical figures that are in charge of making everyone dance.



GOSSIP BOX

Secretariat members are asserting their dominance? The truth will shock you!

As we all know, as a sign of respect, members of committees stand up when a Secretary General comes in. But are the Generals entering rooms for a reason, or are they actually doing it to stroke their egos? During a lunch break, one of the Staff members was bickering with none other than the deputy Secretary, asking "are you only walking in classes just for the delegates to stand up for you?". The bold statement might be more realistic than we think, reflecting a hidden reality from MUNOB.



The 100% most important department is led by the lovely Chiefs of Sponsorship. These guys are the real legends, keeping the green stuff flowing.

Brianna Duta, Stefan Ciurea and Matei Constantinescu, thanks for the pizza.



Next on my personal Hit List we have the ever so present Chiefs of Staff.

Silvia Horga, Catrinel Amariei and Dina Malacopol lead the 'helping hand' of the convention. Sometimes spotted in the wild, these elusive creatures lay in the shadows, organising the minions, making sure that you can enjoy the lovely conference.



Next up are the (cough) slaves (cough), staff members.

Here we have the less important people, the humble house gremlins that toil in the shadows, but the ever so important cogs that keep the beast in motion. And there are so many of them that we are just going to thank them for sharing a substantial part of their time for this incredible event, making the impossible possible.

Many thanks to every single one of them!



The Minister of Education and a European Commissioner visit MUNOB 2022



MUNOB is one of the biggest events for highschoolers. This attracts a lot of attention, and important figures are almost certain to appear. This was the case for MUNOB 2022's first day, when we warmly greeted the National Minister of Education, Sorin Cîmpeanu, and the European Commissioner for Jobs and Social Rights, Nicolas Schmit. After sitting down and discussing with CNMV headmistress, Liliana Zaschevici, they went on to greet the leading MUNOB figures. Waiting for them was the Secretary General Fabiana Severin, President of the General Assembly Teodora Stefan, former student and MUNOB veteran Teodor Matei and prodigy science publisher and student Robin Bucur. Both representatives were very much interested in the procedure that the students followed during the conference. Once acquainted and already having grown fond of the students, the group headed towards the committee rooms and visited each for a couple of minutes. Both guests were pleasantly surprised by the scope of the MUNOB conference and showed their appreciation for the people involved, praising the school and the main MUNOB actors for their dedication. Afterwards, they departed, leaving us with a great sense of pride for having been able to receive such attention.



HOW TO DESTROY A CONTINENT 101

(And How to Fix It Real Quick)

‘Europe is in smithereens. God bless!’

This is what a gossip strip of paper said regarding the state of the European space after the first and second day of conferences in the Crisis Training room. So let’s start at the very beginning, shall we? How did we get to a fractured continent that is filled with hatred and lust for power?

It all started when France left the EU, stating that its president and its people are not happy with what the EU means for their country. After this news, Austria followed suit, supported by Hungary. This further fuelled a separatist movement amidst countries that make up the union.

Many states presented their views on this rather rash decision, starting with Germany and Poland, who emphasized the fact that especially after the Donbass war, the EU should stand strong. The USA also added that France and Austria’s act weakened the region, leaving room for a power struggle to which the States will happily ‘assist with troops, if necessary’. This was what many present in the CRISIS room considered to be the inception to the tensions rising. Suddenly, the word ‘war’ was on everyone’s minds, adding insult to injury.

Following the statements, the directives were presented, and to the surprise of the committee, Austria and Hungary decided to join forces and rekindle the flame of the Austro-Hungarian Empire, now a dual monarchy constituted by the former president of Hungary and the reigning monarch of Austria.

New alliances started to form, as the former united continent of Europe started to simmer. The USA sided with Portugal, UK and Germany, forming what one member described to be the ‘greatest military alliance of all times’. A rather exaggerated statement coming from a bond that didn’t seem too trustworthy.

The next event certainly shook that alliance, seeing that the US President, Joe Biden, sadly passed away. Following his unfortunate death, the people of America looked up to his successor in office. That is how Kamala Harris took the reign of the most powerful country in the world. After this sudden change in leadership, the state was shaken and bewildered by a power struggle as Ted Cruise tried to take control from Texas.

Meanwhile, back in Europe, the UK tried to invade Ireland, failing rather shamefully, even with the help of the US. After the military campaign that was stopped by the Irish people, the US retracted its support of the British troops, stating that it does not want to get involved in another conflict.

Seeing the weakened country of America start to tremble under what seemed like the possibility of civil war, countries from the Central European alliance, with the Habsburg monarchy leading the pack, started to prepare for what seemed to be an offensive attempt against the US. Thankfully, the conflict did not escalate, with Europe being now engulfed in another controversy, as the German delegate managed to decrypt the encoded message discovered. The short text translated to ‘the queen is having an affair with Andrevj [...] (president of Poland) and if this comes out, then she will be dead, as it is against Polish policy’. This rather spicy bit of gossip was soon investigated, as in the committee there were only two queens, the English queen and the Spanish one, the latter being only 19 of age. After a simple rationale, the only viable option remaining was the younger monarch.



In minutes, delegates from both countries were frantically investigating the authenticity of the message.

After one more crisis was momentarily avoided, the room carried on, and by the end of the day, the USA was left all alone on its continent, losing most support, while back in Europe, the EU was no more. Oh, and the USA invaded the Habsburg Empire.

TL;DR: a new empire emerged, was then invaded by the US, Ukraine is now friends with Russia, the EU is gone, the USA is stranded diplomatically, a 19-year-old queen has been having an affair with a 54-year-old Polish president, and Joe Biden died... did I miss anything? Probably nothing of major importance.

Got it? Me neither. Tomorrow, this hot mess will be fixed.

But before we get to that, I want to thank the sponsors for the much needed help they supplied: AF Consulting, BTL Real NFC 69 Prod Company SRL, RUVIX T-shirts and More, Jerry's Pizza (truly lovely pizza) and Sacose-Bumbac.ro.

So, there they were, on a fine Sunday morning, all the delegates, ever ready to fix the mess that they had 'accidentally' created. They sat down and started to undo all the damage. First on the house cleaning list was the problem of the Russian-Ukrainian tensions created by the troops that the US stationed at the border. The Russians pushed a bunch of clauses forward, featuring referendums, the retreat of the troops and so on. Ukraine remained a somewhat neutral state, but was allowed to sway to the European side. China wanted countries to not invade other states, such as Ireland and the Habsburg Empire, so that amendment passed right away. The USA abstained or was generally against the motions proposed, stating that 'we do not trust that Russia is peaceful'. The USA and the UK were supposed to offer monetary compensation for citizens that were affected by this unnecessary war, yet the Americans were only willing to pay for the Habsburg conflict.

UNLIMITED Q&A was requested, with every country hoping to understand how on earth the US could be so bloody incoherent. Unfortunately, the chairpersons limited the amount of questions to only two. We managed to capture some of them:

'What is your problem with Irish people?', asked the delegate of the Austro-Hungarian state.

"We cannot respond to that.", the USA replied.

... and many more pearls such as the ones above.

A system of restrictions was implemented by the Chinese delegate to further limit the possibility of future wars. And in the end, the US was almost completely excluded from the European area, being left with a clause in the final form of the motion, forcing it to respect all other clauses or face dire consequences.

As the day came close to an end, Europe was closer and closer to becoming a better place. After all the wars and misunderstandings the European space was inches away from reaching the long sought after peace.

This committee learned a lot during the 3 days of fierce debate, and I think there isn't anyone that would say MUNOB 2022 wasn't an incredible experience, as they left with a smile on their face and a ton of new friends.



MUNOB 2022

In the field

France is scared of robots

As weird as it may sound, this phrase is exactly what one might be left with after participating in the DISEC council at MUNOB 2022. With the main topic being the use of autonomous weapons in global warfare, the debate was fierce, with countries such as India, China, DPRK and its southern neighbor, South Korea, stating that AWs are the future. To this, France responded in a rather interesting fashion, claiming that 'AI might develop consciousness and advanced technology is dangerous, and this is why France is sceptical about the usage of AWs.

What if AI becomes aware of its own existence and identity and starts hurting humankind?! Even if it is implausible, France believes so'. This statement was corroborated by other nations opposing the use of AWs, the term 'killer robots' being the most uttered in the DISEC committee. North Korea was by far the most vocal country, adding that the DPRK considers AW to be the nuclear weapons of the future, and that the country would not refrain from using them if the opposing states were to use these weapons first. In a private interview, they also mentioned that DPRK is a 'proud country, peaceful and responsible, unlike others'. As for France, I suspect 'Terminator' was too much for its wine-loving citizens to handle.



Russia is being rude to the press.

The USA is also being rude to the press.

China, in a rather surprising fashion, is not.



Russia has a history of trying to negate the power of the press. Since the Soviet Revolution in 1918, the Russian state has been controlling the press locally, and the delegate of Russia has not thanked the press on multiple occasions. The US delegate, showcasing a stereotypically egocentric view of the world, did not acknowledge the presence of the press (that would be me), even though the placard of the press was sufficiently legible and written in the lovely color of pitch black.

China, although criticized numerous times by the other countries due to its stifling of freedom of speech, in a surprising turn of events, recognised the press, and so it must be praised, right here and now. Thank you, China! Much love from the editor of this magazine.



MUNOB 2022

'The mind of the crowd'

The Three Kidnappings The Hunger Games at ECOFIN

"One snack and one bottle a day" had been the rule for each participant at MUNOB. It was an understandable way to ensure that there were enough supplies left for everyone. But, apparently, the rule did not go well with all the delegates. On the third day of MUNOB a kidnapping was reported. The Congo delegate was literally lifted in the air and taken away from her committee by some delegates. A truly scary incident... The reason? Food ransom. The kidnapper asked for snacks, water and even mobile phones in exchange of the delegate. What an outrageous way to sneak more food!

HRC's Love At First Sight

Delegates were not only greedy for resources during MUNOB, but also for love! With handsome boys in suits, who wouldn't start having crushes? There had been a mysterious link left on a note in the HRC's gossip box. What was the link hiding, you might ask? When the chairs entered it into their computers, the video-projector showed a picture with a familiar face.

It was Octavian Cravenco's, one of the UNODC Chairs, photo with a heart drawn over and a message saying: "My love!" This incident was foreshadowing his upcoming kidnapping by the members of HRC. The

Human Rights Council stormed into the chair's committee and abducted the Chair member as a sign of adoration. Isn't this a violation of human rights?



The Russian Ambush

The Crisis committee was truly a hot, but delicious, glorified mess, with countries fighting or making alliances here and there and memorable moments. But one fight that stood out, congruent with nowadays crisis, was between Ukraine and Russia. Russia's delegate from UNODC marched down the stairs heading towards the Crisis room, followed by other countries, ready for attack. Russia charged at Ukraine, put a bag over his head, and kidnaped him victoriously. This whole ambush was aimed at proving that Russia had won the battle.



GOSSIP BOX

Forbidden love between exes? Sexiest MUNOB couple?!

Two stars arose from the Crisis committee. Recreating the historic Austro-Hungarian Empire and sharing the same seat, the chemistry and tension between Austria and Hungary was almost palpable. All the roleplaying and steamy interactions left us shocked and questioning: "They still didn't kiss?!"



The dancing

To participate in munob you have to excel in critical thinking, public speaking and research. But a not so known crucial requirement is: DANCING!

After receiving lots of punishments, and having members stolen, ECOFIN wanted to lighten up the mood and come up with an innovative POE. All the members of ECOFIN gathered the ones from DISEC grouping up in a line and started dancing. Seeing the noise across the hallways, the other committees joined the dancing queue, resulting in a funny train of people.



The (almost) All Girls Committee. Girl Power or Pure Chaos?

On the never-ending search for content, the press stumbled upon heated arguments at ECOFIN, the committee with only one boy delegate drowning in a sea of girls. The tones used by the girls while debating were sassy and at times intimidating. In an interview, the delegates of Israel and Kenya said the debate was so heated that it got inappropriate.

After a quick interview, one of the chair members stated "I think that they (the delegates) should reach a compromise-". But how could they do that, if the committee is represented by such fiery and determined natures? Maybe the wrangles came from the astrological incompatibilities between the girls. Maybe there were a lot of scorpions or fire signs. Who knows?

BONUS

Interview with the only man at ECOFIN

Q: 'How do you feel to be the only boy in the committee made up of almost all girls?'

'I feel like the girls in my class'

Q: 'Have you been given less food?'

'Fortunately, no'

For this next part of the interview, we asked for privacy:

Q: 'Do you think that if there were more boys in the committee would the decisions be more balanced?'

'Yes I do, because they always proposed to empower women to solve any problem'

His name has been kept a secret to protect his identity.





***WE WAIT FOR YOU NEXT YEAR!
SEE YOU THERE!***



The end.